

Nathan Turczan

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SUMMARY

Product designer who ships the products he designs. Eight years designing creative software across iOS, iPadOS, macOS, and web, and shipping it end to end, including documentation, development, and testing. I take intricate, workflow-driven problems (real-time harmony, networked performance, pitch correction) and turn them into elegant, direct-manipulation experiences, tested and refined with real users. AI is part of my daily design process: describe, prototype in high fidelity, and refine, all backed by a knowledge base that compounds. MFA from CalArts; published at NIME. Deep in creative-app craft, from layout and typography to motion and behavior.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Product Designer - Scale Navigator, LLC 2021 - Present

- Designed, built, and shipped a suite of music-creation tools across web, iOS, Android, macOS/Windows desktop, and DAW plugins (VST3/AU, **Logic Pro compatible**) as the sole designer and developer (project began 2018; incorporated 2021)

Products Shipped:

- Scale Navigator Dashboard** – direct-manipulation instrument for navigating harmonic space (based on Tymoczko's *Geometry of Music*); one source of truth for scale/chord state, broadcast via MIDI and parameter automation (Web, iOS, Android, VST3, AU)
- Ensemble Jammer** – networked multiplayer instruments where the interface guarantees no wrong notes; non-musician to ensemble in under 60 seconds (Web, iOS)
- Tonalign** – real-time MIDI pitch correction; wrong notes become right notes (VST3, AU)
- SNaPS** – scale-aware sampler with three engines (Emitter, Looper, Sequencer); AI sample-ingestion (Spotify's Basic Pitch) auto-tags pitch-class metadata
- NotesChordScales** – real-time chord and scale inference (Web, AU)

Product Manager & Sound Designer - FutureCare 2022 - 2025

- Led product for **Wave of Wellness** (iOS/Android), a React Native wellness dashboard integrating 5+ sensor types (motion, bed, door, medication, air quality); 9 agency partnerships, ~60 active installs
- Iterated on Wave of Wellness UI in **Figma** with UI designer Yeji Li: layout explorations, navigation A/Bs, visual-direction studies
- Shipped a custom **Crestron Home Driver** (published on the Crestron Drivers Portal); coordinated cross-functional teams, ran Agile and pilots

Sound Designer - Output Inc. 2021

- Sound design and kit creation for **Arcade**, Output's flagship subscription instrument

Associate Product Manager - SPG Studios 2020 - 2021

- APM for **Remoto**, cloud ADR software for film/TV post-production; owned milestones and specs

Adjunct Instructor - California Institute of the Arts 2021 - 2022

- Taught Media + Web Development (Music Technology): weekly lectures, live demos, and group critique sessions

Composer & Interaction Designer - Freelance 2018 - Present

- SOULS** (2022) with Sia & David O'Reilly – designed and prototyped the interactive music system for 10,000 digital characters (21-chord vocabulary, constant-power crossfade); #3 on Billboard's digital-collectibles ranking (July 2022), Designboom, Forbes
- Refik Anadol Studio's** *WDCH Dreams* (LA Phil centennial) – sound-file tagging and data prep
- CTO, **Chordas Collective** (vocal-electronic ensemble); Founder, **LA Laptop Orchestra** (participatory music project); scores for iHeartRadio

SKILLS

Design: Product & interaction design, visual design (layout, typography, motion), high-fidelity prototyping in code, design systems, usability testing, Figma

Build: React, TypeScript, Web Audio API, Tone.js, D3.js, Firebase, JUCE/C++, MIDI

Domain: Creative-app & instrument design, music theory, DAW plugins (VST3/AU)

EDUCATION

MFA, Music Technology - California Institute of the Arts 2019

BA, Vocal Performance - UC Santa Cruz 2013

Workshop in Algorithmic Computer Music - UC Santa Cruz (studied directly under David Cope) 2012

SPEAKING & PUBLICATION

Invited Lectures: [Stanford CCRMA](#), [California Institute of the Arts](#), Middlebury College (all 2026)

Publication: Turczan, N. (2019). [The Scale Navigator: A System for Networked Algorithmic Harmony](#). NIME 2019.